



Garcia Family Medicine
BLUE SPRINGS · MISSOURI

YOUR SEASON-LONG WELLNESS COMPANION

The Summer Health & *Safety* Guide

Beat the heat, dodge the bugs, and make the most of every sunny day — **fun activity ideas and simple safety know-how**, brought to you by Dr. Tess and the GFM team.



20+ summer-safety tips

12 activity ideas

Your doctor a **text away**

Make It a Healthy Summer



Summer in the Kansas City metro means pools, parks, ball games, and backyard cookouts — and a few seasonal hazards worth knowing. This little guide is our gift to you: the **practical stuff** that keeps summer fun, plus easy ideas to stay active as a family.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

- Spotting & preventing heat illness
- Hydration & sun protection
- Bites, stings & summer skin
- 12 family activity ideas
- Water, travel & cookout safety
- Fun summer health factoids

THE GFM ADVANTAGE

With a **Direct Primary Care** membership, you never have to wonder whether something's "worth a visit." A bad sting, a rash that won't quit, a fever on a holiday weekend — **just text Dr. Tess**. No phone trees, no rushed appointments, often same-day answers from a doctor who knows your whole family.



Dr. Theresa "Tess" Garcia, MD, FAFP, DABOM — board-certified in Family & Obesity Medicine, caring for Blue Springs families for 20+ years. **This guide is general wellness information, not a substitute for personal care.**

Beat the Heat

When the body can't cool itself, trouble builds fast. Knowing the two stages — and acting early — can prevent an emergency.

Heat Exhaustion

- Heavy sweating; cool, clammy, pale skin
- Dizziness, headache, nausea
- Weak, fast pulse; muscle cramps

WHAT TO DO

Move to shade/AC, sip water, loosen clothing, apply cool wet cloths. Rest until fully recovered.

Heat Stroke

EMERGENCY

- Temp 103°F+; hot, red, dry or damp skin
- Confusion, slurred speech, fainting
- Strong, racing pulse

⚠️ CALL 911 IMMEDIATELY

Move to cool, cool aggressively (wet skin, fan, ice packs to neck/arm pits). Don't give fluids if not fully alert.

#1

Top weather killer

Heat causes more U.S. deaths most years than floods, tornadoes or hurricanes.

10_{min}

Never leave anyone in a car

Interiors can climb ~20°F in 10 minutes — deadly for kids & pets.



Higher-risk

Infants, older adults, athletes & some meds raise heat risk. Check on neighbors.

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Not sure if it's heat exhaustion? GFM members can **text Dr. Tess** for same-day guidance — and we'll tell you fast if it's a 911 situation.

Hydration & Sun Safety

💧 Drink Before You're Thirsty

Thirst lags behind your body's needs, so sip steadily all day — don't wait for the dry mouth.

STAY AHEAD OF IT

- Carry water; add fruit or a pinch of electrolytes on sweaty days
- Limit sugary & alcoholic drinks — they dry you out
- Pee-check: pale yellow = good; dark = drink up
- "Eat your water": watermelon, cucumber & berries are ~90% water



☀️ Smart Sun Protection

✓ SPF 30+, broad-spectrum

Reapply every 2 hours & after swimming or sweating.

✓ Don't forget spots

Ears, nose, neck, scalp part & tops of feet burn easily.

✓ Seek shade 10am–4pm

UV is strongest midday — hats & sunglasses help too.

✓ Burn? Cool & moisturize

Cool bath, aloe, fluids; see us for blistering burns.

15min

Sunburn starts fast

Unprotected skin can burn in as little as 15 minutes of midday sun.

1.5L

Sweat adds up

You can lose over a liter of fluid an hour in the heat — replace it.

Heads-up: some prescriptions increase sun & heat sensitivity. Ask Dr. Tess whether any of yours do.

Bites, Stings & Bugs

🐝 Bee & Wasp Stings

Scrape the stinger out sideways — don't pinch (that pushes in more venom). Wash, then cold compress.

- Ice 10 min on/off for swelling
- Antihistamine for itch, ibuprofen for pain

⚠️ CALL 911 IF

Lips/tongue/throat swell, hives spread, or breathing is hard — use an EpiPen if prescribed.

🦟 Mosquitoes & Ticks

PREVENT

- EPA-approved repellent; cover skin at dusk
- Dump standing water around the yard
- Check for ticks after trails & tall grass

TICK FOUND?

Pull straight out with tweezers at the skin. Watch for a spreading rash, fever or aches — and tell us.

♥️ Know the Warning Signs of a Serious Reaction

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| ⓘ Trouble breathing or swallowing | ⓘ Swelling of lips, tongue or throat |
| ⓘ Dizziness or fainting | ⓘ Hives spreading beyond the sting |

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Nastybite or sting that isn't calming down? GFM offers **same-daycare** — text a photo and we'll guide you on what's normal and what needs to be seen.

Summer Skin

Heat, sweat, sun and plants all test your skin in summer. Most flare-ups are minor and settle quickly with simple care.

❁ Heat Rash

Trapped sweat plugs the skin's ducts, leaving tiny red, prickly bumps — often in folds, on the neck or chest.

SOOTHE & PREVENT

Cool down, keep skin **dry**, wear loose cotton, skip heavy creams. Usually clears in a few days.

☀️ Sunburn Relief

- Cool bath/compress; aloe or fragrance-free lotion
- Extra fluids; ibuprofen for pain
- Leave blisters intact; don't peel

⚠️ SEE A DOCTOR FOR

Widespread blistering, fever, chills or signs of dehydration.

🍃 Poison Ivy, Oak & Sumac

LEAVES OF 3

"Leaves of three, let it be." The oil (urushiol) causes an itchy, blistering rash 12–72 hours after contact.

RIGHT AWAY

Rinse skin with soap & cool water within the hour; wash clothes, tools & pets that touched it.

⚠️ GET CARE IF

Rash hits the face/eyes/grain, covers large areas, or oozes & spreads — we can help calm it.

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Rashes are easy to misread. Snap a photo and text it — Dr. Tess can often tell you what it is and what to do, no appointment needed.

12 Smart Summer Activities



Swimming

Cool, low-impact, great for all ages. **Swim with a buddy; watch kids closely.**



Family Bike Rides

Explore the trails together. **Helmets on; go early to beat the heat.**



Nature Walks & Hikes

Free, easy, good for the heart. **Water, sunscreen, bug spray; check for ticks.**



Gardening

Gentle strength & stress relief. **Hat, gloves, shade breaks, hydrate.**



Backyard Sports

Catch, soccer, frisbee. **Warm up; take water & shade time outs.**



Farmers Markets

Walk & shop fresh produce. **Morning trips dodge midday heat.**



Sunrise/Sunset Strolls

Beat the heat at the cool ends of day. **Reflective gear after dark.**



Picnics in the Park

Family time outdoors. **Keep cold food cold; shade the spread.**



Sprinkler & Water Play

Kid-favorite way to cool off. **Non-slip surfaces; supervise always.**



Yoga / Stretch on the Lawn

Calm, flexible, joint-friendly. **Early shade; mat & water.**



Splash Pads & Pools

Great for little ones. **Reapply sunscreen; rest in shade.**



Evening Ball Games

Community fun & cardio. **Hydrate; bug spray at dusk.**



Want to get moving toward a healthier you? Dr. Tess is **board-certified in Obesity Medicine** — ask about a personalized, doctor-led plan to make this summer a turning point.

Water, Travel & Cookout Safety



Water Safety

- Never swim alone; actively watch kids — drowning is silent
- Life jackets on boats & open water (not floaties)
- Enter feet-first in unknown water; know the depth
- Learn the signs of “dry/quiet” drowning after a scare

Cookout Food Safety

- Keep cold food cold; don't leave it out over 2 hrs (1 hr if 90°F+)
- Separate raw & cooked; use a meat thermometer
- Wash hands & surfaces; clean the cooler

Road-Trip Ready

- ✓ **Water & snacks for everyone**
Stretch & hydrate every couple of hours.
- ✓ **Bring your meds & a list**
Plus GFM's number saved in your phone.
- ✓ **Pack a basic first-aid kit**
Bandages, antihistamine, pain reliever, sunscreen.
- ✓ **Never leave kids/pets in the car**
Not even for a quick errand.

Traveling as a GFM member? Your doctor is still a text away — handy for questions on the road when you're far from home.

DID YOU KNOW?

Summer Health Factoids

A handful of surprising-but-true facts to share around the cooler.



Bees sting once; wasps don't

Honeybees die after stinging — wasps & hornets can sting again and again. Back away calmly, don't swat.



Humidity makes heat worse

In muggy air, sweat can't evaporate — so your body's main cooling system stalls.



You can eat your water

Watermelon, cucumber & strawberries are about 90% water — tasty hydration.



Hooch's tip

Dogs cool by panting, not sweating. Shade, water & cool ground keep our Comfort Specialist happy.



UV sneaks through clouds

Up to 80% of UV passes through clouds — you can burn on an overcast day.



Thirst is a late signal

By the time you feel thirsty you're already mildly dehydrated — sip ahead of it.



Cars heat up shockingly fast

On an 80°F day a car can pass 100°F in minutes — never leave kids or pets.



Still water = mosquitoes

They breed in tiny amounts of standing water. Empty saucers, buckets & gutters weekly.

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Health questions all summer long? That's exactly what your **GFM membership** is for — real answers from a doctor who knows you, whenever you need them.

YOUR SUMMER HEALTH PARTNER

Garcia Family Medicine

More than a guide — we're your doctor. One simple membership covers everyday care for the whole family, with extra services all under one roof.



Direct Primary Care • \$99/mo

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Medical Weight Management

Doctor-led, board-certified obesity medicine



CoreLift Pelvic Health

FDA-cleared EMSELLA technology



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DOT Physicals & IMEs

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Physicals, screenings, chronic-care & more

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VISIT

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HOURS

Tue – Fri • 11am – 6pm

Become a Patient

garciafamilymedicine.care

A note from GFM: This guide shares general summer wellness information and is **not a substitute for personal medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment**. For heat stroke, a severe allergic reaction or any emergency, **call 911**. Questions about your own health? Reach out to Dr. Tess anytime.